

REAL ESTATE STRATEGIES

What it’s really like to invest in Indianapolis

How one investor fell in love with the city even though he doesn’t live there.



Nicholas Fernandes/Bright Bloom Real Estate; Nicholas Klein/Getty Images (city).

By [Judy Dutton](#)

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Boston resident Nicholas Fernandes of [Bright Bloom Real Estate](#) owns four properties in Indianapolis. Here’s why he looked beyond his own backyard.

Average home price: \$233,674 (down 0.2% YoY)

Homes that sell over list price: 18.0%

Homes that sell under list price: 58.2%

Average rent: \$1,413/month

The pros: “Indianapolis sits in that sweet spot between affordability and stability,” says Fernandes. “Beyond just low cost, what stands out is consistent rental demand driven by a steady job base, healthcare, logistics, and education, which keep occupancy stable compared to more volatile markets. We also see solid rent-to-price ratios, which make it attractive for investors focused on cash flow.”

The cons: “Unless you’re adding value, appreciation is typically slower here than in coastal areas, so it’s not a rapid flip environment,” he says. “Plus some suburban neighborhoods have pockets of overbuilding, so hyper-local information is crucial because purchasing on the wrong block can completely alter the outcome.”

His advice: “The biggest lesson for me was about geographic humility: Just because a market isn’t glamorous doesn’t mean the numbers don’t work,” he says.

“Boston, where I live, is where I wanted to buy. But the numbers didn’t work for me there. Indianapolis did.” Another tip? Even though homes here may be cheap, “Don’t naively pursue ‘cheap’ transactions,” he warns. “In Indianapolis, the opportunity lies not in speculation but in prudent purchasing and management. It does very well if you approach it like a long-term yield play and concentrate on fundamentals.”

Got a home or housing market you want to highlight in The Playbook? Tell us more about it here, and we’ll consider featuring it in an upcoming issue.

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